

Google Calendar Quick Start Guide

Quick Start Guide | Tools & Productivity

Audience: Executive assistants and administrative staff

Estimated Read Time: 8 minutes

Version: 1.1 (October 7, 2026)

Portfolio sample. The screenshots use a fictional calendar and fictional guests.

Introduction

This guide provides essential steps for scheduling and managing executive meetings using Google Calendar.

Key Features

- Create and edit events
- Add guests and check availability
- Manage recurring meetings
- Attach documents to events

Before You Begin

- You need a Google account with access to Google Calendar in a web browser. Menu names in this guide match the web version and may change over time.
- Check your own time zone in Settings > General > Time zone before you schedule anything.
- To manage an executive's calendar, you need their permission. Follow the steps in **Working With an Executive's Calendar** later in this guide.

Scheduling a Meeting

1. In Google Calendar, select "Create" and then "Event" from the drop down menu.
2. Enter the meeting title.
3. Enter the meeting location or meeting link for virtual attendees.
4. Select the timing for meeting notification reminders.
5. Enter the meeting description, agenda, and attach relevant documents (briefing notes, presentations, action trackers, etc.).
6. Add guests and review their availability using the "Find a time" feature.
7. For multi-region meetings, confirm each guest's displayed time zone before sending (e.g., ET/PT for U.S. attendees, GST for UAE attendees).
8. Click "Save" and "Send" invitations.

Create
Event

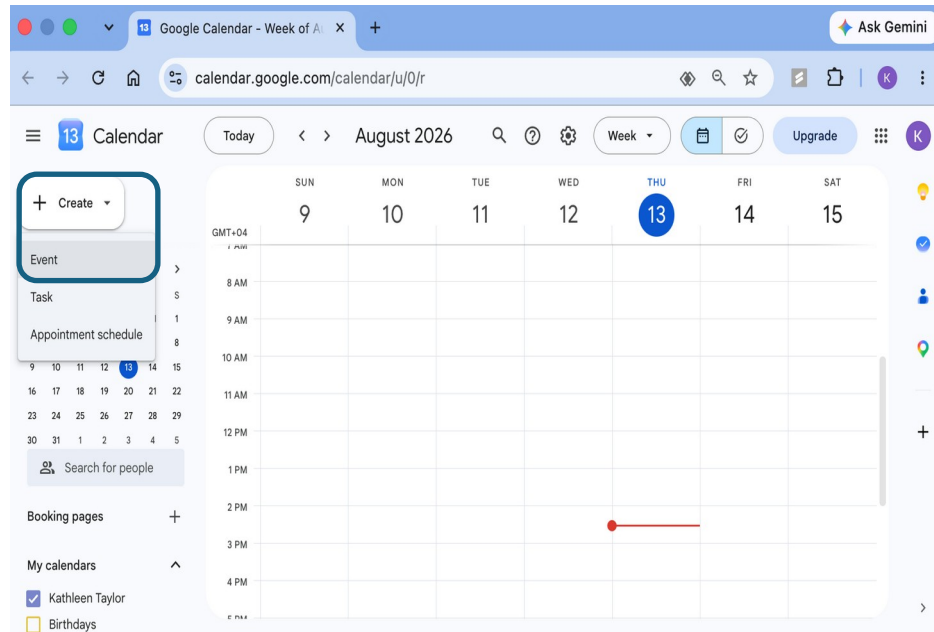


Figure 1. Google Calendar event creation panel

Title

Location

Reminders

Description,
Agenda, and
Attachments

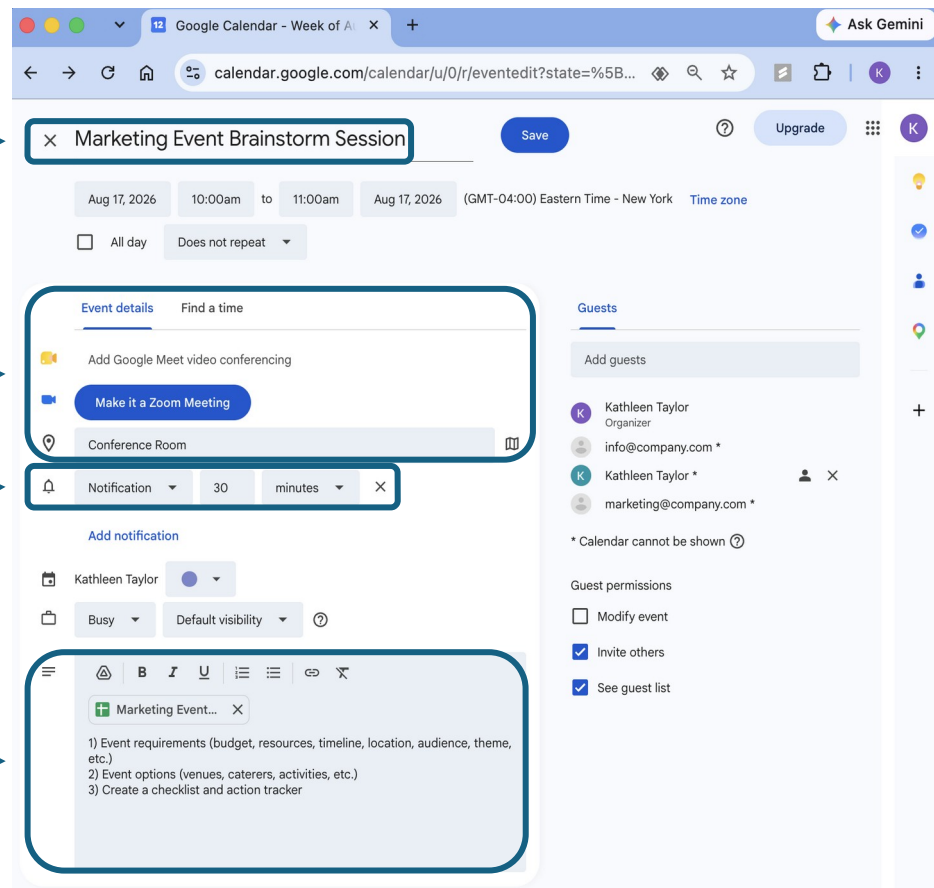


Figure 2. Event details panel

All guests are free at
10:00-11:00 AM
Eastern Time

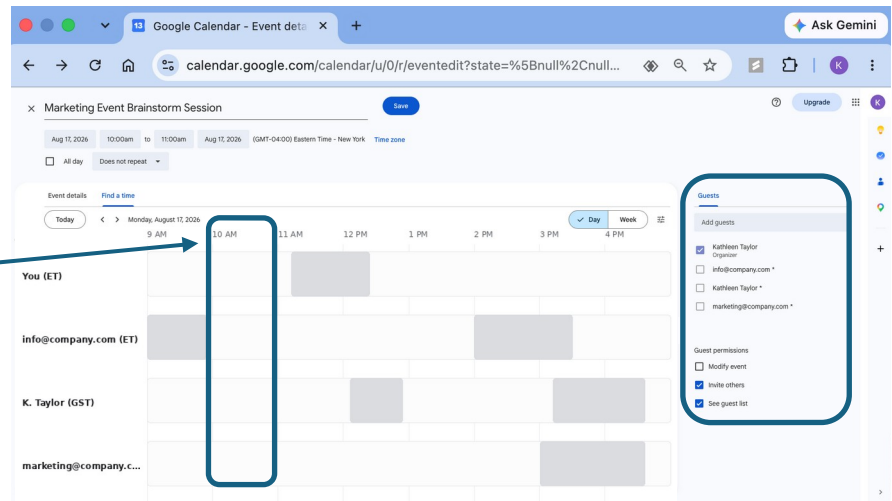


Figure 3. Add guests, and "Find a time" availability view across time

Save

Send

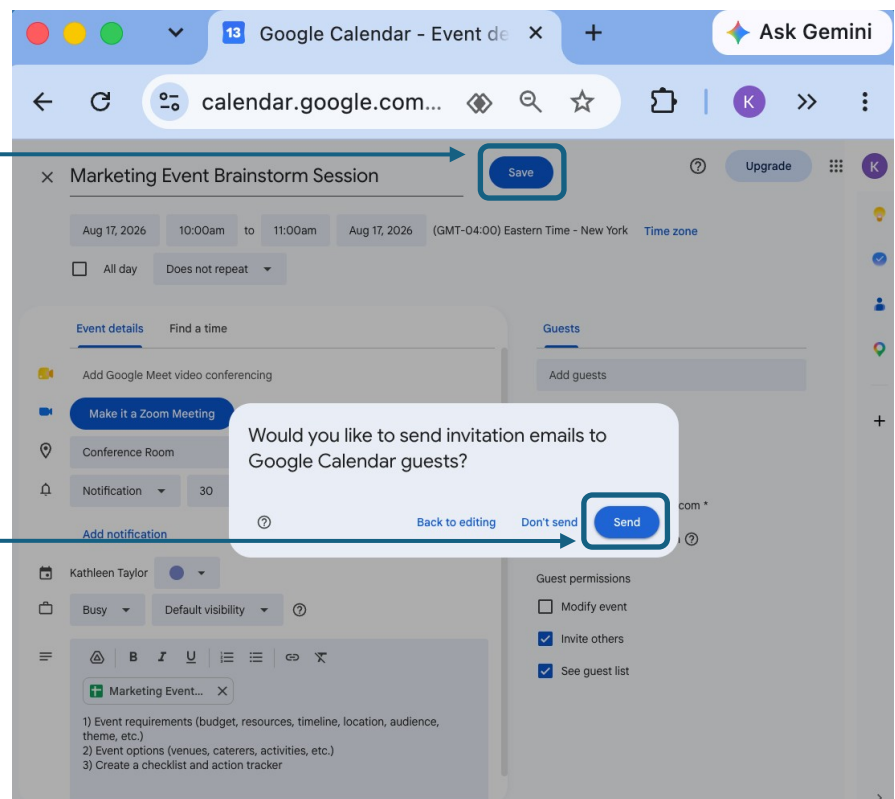


Figure 4. "Save" and "Send" event invitation

Managing Recurring Events

Select the recurrence option when creating an event to set a repeat pattern (daily, weekly, monthly, or custom). Use "This event" vs. "All events" carefully when editing a single occurrence of a recurring series to avoid unintentionally changing the whole series.

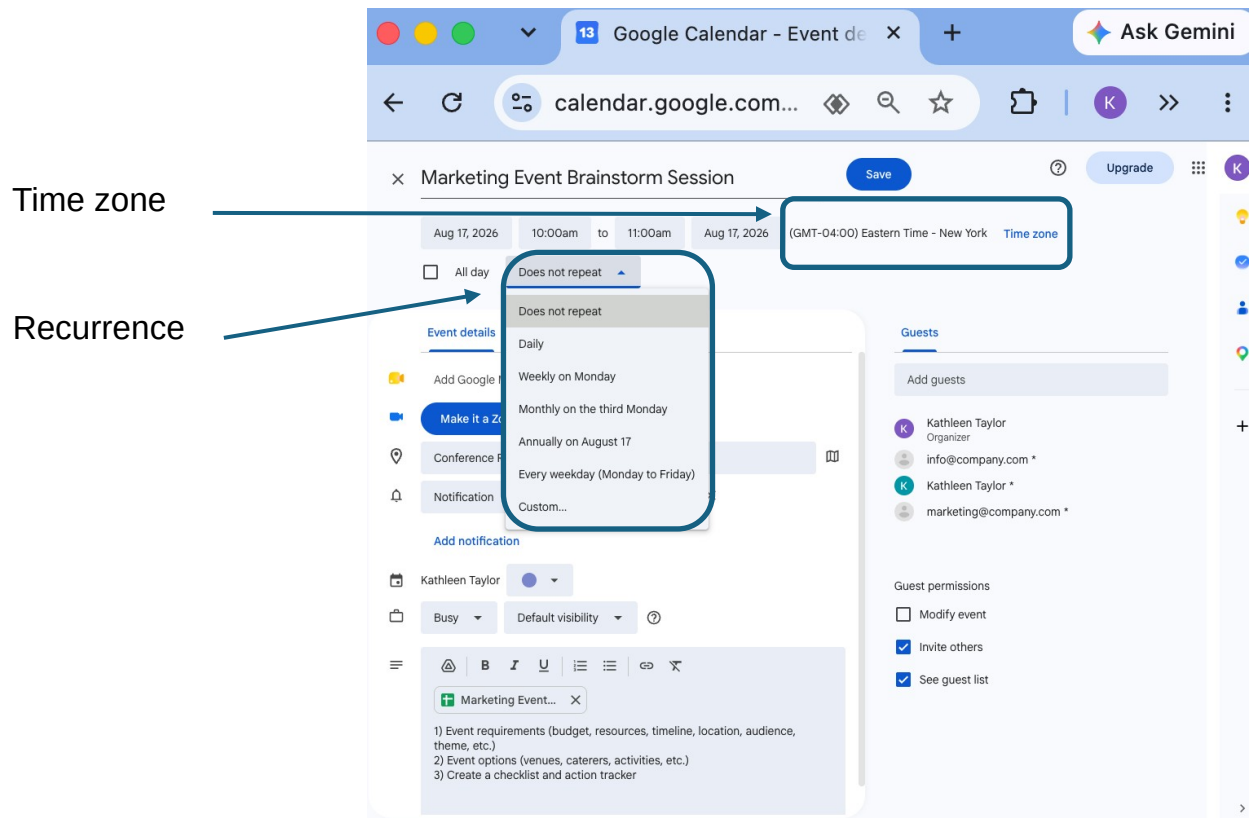


Figure 5. Recurrence settings and multi-time zone

Best Practices

- Use color coding for meeting categories.
- Add reminders for high-priority meetings.
- Include a clear agenda in the event description.
- For cross-time-zone scheduling (common for US/UAE coordination), always double-check the displayed time zone before sending.

Working With an Executive's Calendar

Before you can manage an executive's calendar, they must share it with you. The executive completes these steps:

1. Open Google Calendar and select Settings (the gear icon), then Settings.
2. Under Settings for my calendars, select their calendar.
3. Select Share with specific people or groups, then Add people and groups.
4. Enter your email address and set the permission to **Make changes to events**.
5. Select Send.

Accept the invitation if you are prompted. The executive's calendar then appears under Other calendars in your left sidebar, and you can create and edit events on it. If you can only view events, ask the executive to check the permission level.

Rescheduling and Cancelling

Rescheduling an event

1. Open the event and change the date or time, or drag the event to a new slot on the calendar.
2. Click Save.
3. When asked whether to send updates to guests, choose Send so everyone sees the new time.

Cancelling an event

1. Open the event and click the trash icon (Delete event).
2. Choose Send when asked whether to email cancellations to guests, so no one waits for a meeting that is not happening.
3. For a recurring series, choose **This event**, **This and following events**, or **All events** with care.

If you delete an event by mistake, click Undo right away, or restore it from Trash (events are kept for 30 days).

Working Across Time Zones

- Add a second time zone to your calendar view in Settings > General > Time zone, using Display secondary time zone.
- Set the executive's working hours in Settings > Working hours & location, so colleagues see when they are available.
- When creating an event, use the Time zone link beneath the date and time to set a different time zone for the start and end (see Figure 5).
- Before sending, open Find a time and confirm each guest's local time, especially for U.S. and UAE attendees.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	What to do
Find a time shows no availability for a guest	The guest has not shared their calendar, or is outside your organization	Propose two or three times by email, or ask the guest to share free or busy information.
Guests see the wrong time	The event was created in the wrong time zone	Open the event, click the Time zone link, correct it, then Save and Send the update.
The whole recurring series changed	"All events" was selected when editing one occurrence	Click Undo immediately. Otherwise edit the series back to its original details.
A guest did not receive the invitation	Send was not selected, the address has a typo, or the message went to spam	Open the event, check the address, and use Email guests to resend.
You cannot edit the executive's event	You only have view permission	Ask the executive to change your permission to Make changes to events.

Keyboard Shortcuts

These shortcuts are specific to Google Calendar on the web and work the same on Windows and Mac. They are single keys, so no Ctrl or Command is needed. Turn them on in Settings > General > Keyboard shortcuts, then press the keys while the calendar page is open. Press ? to see the full list.

Key	Action
c	Create a new event
t	Go to today
d, w, m	Switch to day, week, or month view
j or n	Go to the next period
k or p	Go to the previous period
/	Search your calendar